

Characterisation of interaction potentials for Nitrogen at low temperature ($T < 600\text{ K}$) from transport properties and rotational relaxation

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Transitional Flows*

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Summary

- 1 PES
- 2 Trajectories
- 3 Raman
- 4 Rotational relaxation
- 5 Conclusions

PES from Perugia

An Experimental Potential Energy Surface and Calculated Rotovibrational Levels of the Molecular $N_2 - N_2$ Nitrogen Dimer

V. Aquilanti *et al.*, *J. Chem. Phys.* **117**, 615 (2002)

- **Motivation**: characterization of the $N_2 - N_2$ dimer
- **Approach**: analysis of molecular beams scattering data and second virial coefficients
- **Results**: bound rotovibrational states of the dimer for $J \leq 6$

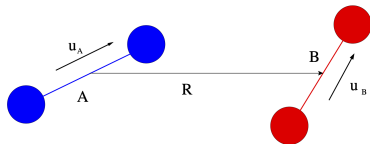
PES from Hellmann

Ab initio potential energy surface for the nitrogen molecule pair and thermophysical properties of nitrogen gas

R. Hellmann, *Molecular Physics* **111**, 387 (2013)

- **Motivation**: Thermophysical properties (transport, virial coefficients)
- **Approach**: fitting over 400 energy configurations from quantum electronic structure calculations
- **Results**: shear viscosity thermal conductivity, 2nd & 3rd virial coefficients

Trajectory & Scattering simulations



Equations of motion

$$\dot{\mathbf{R}} = \mathbf{v}$$

$$m_r \dot{\mathbf{v}} = \mathbf{F}_B$$

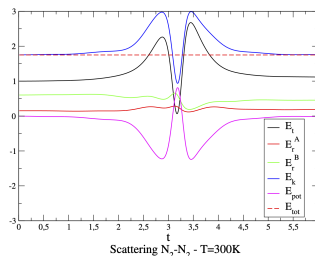
$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_A = \boldsymbol{\omega}_A \wedge \mathbf{u}_A$$

$$\mathcal{I} \dot{\boldsymbol{\omega}}_A = \mathbf{T}_A$$

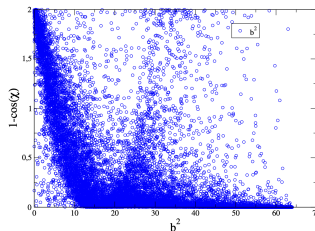
$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_B = \boldsymbol{\omega}_B \wedge \mathbf{u}_B$$

$$\mathcal{I} \dot{\boldsymbol{\omega}}_B = \mathbf{T}_B$$

Energy dynamics in N_2-N_2 collision



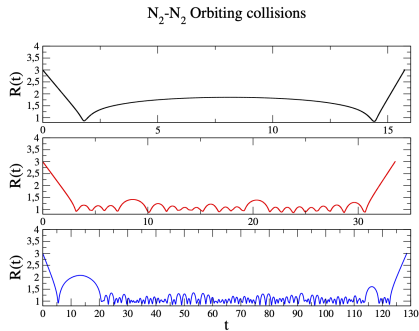
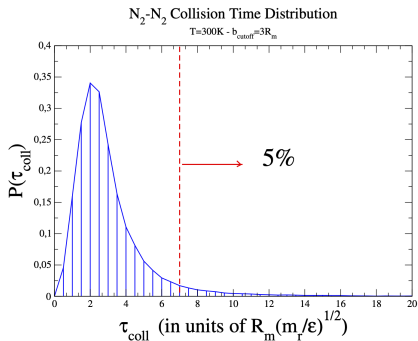
Scattering N_2-N_2 - $T=300K$



CT-MC estimation of N_2 transport

Approach

Monte Carlo integration of Chapman-Enskog expressions (1st approximation)

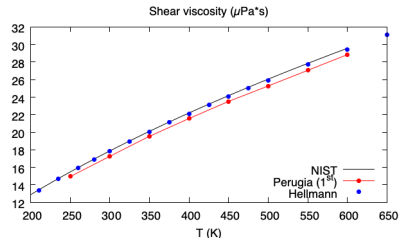
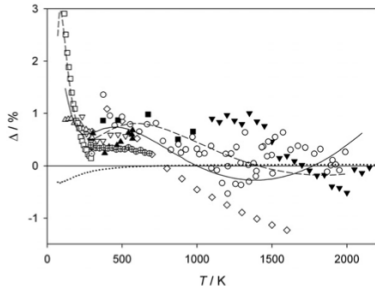


Results I. Shear viscosity

Theory: C-E 1st approximation

$$\eta = \frac{5k_B T}{8\Omega^{(2,2)}}$$

$$\Omega^{(2,2)} \sim \int (1 - \cos^2 \chi) \dots dgdb$$



NIST

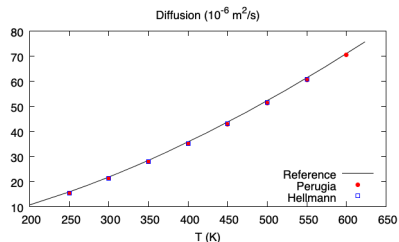
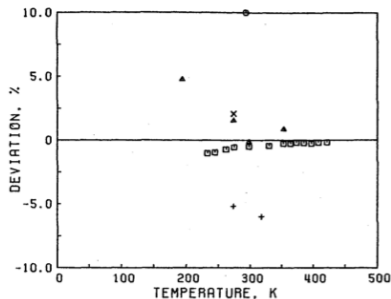
Viscosity and Thermal Conductivity Equations for Nitrogen, Oxygen, Argon, and Air
E.W. Lemmon, R.T. Jacobsen, *International Journal of Thermophysics* **25** 21 (2004)

Results II. Diffusion

Theory: C-E 1st approximation

$$\mathfrak{D} = \frac{3k_B T}{8nm\Omega^{(1,1)}}$$

$$\Omega^{(1,1)} \sim \int (1 - \cos \chi) \dots dgdb$$



Source

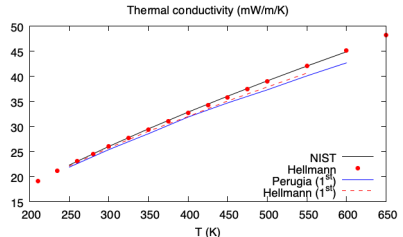
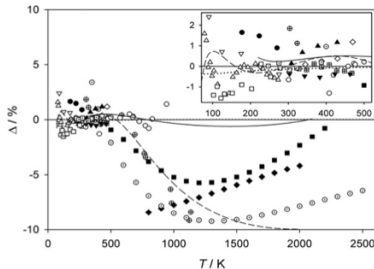
Equilibrium and Transport Properties of Eleven Polyatomic Gases At Low Density
 A. Boushehri *et al.*, *Journal of Phys. Chem. Ref. Data* **16** 445 (1987)

Results III. Thermal conductivity

Theory: C-E 1st approximation

$$\lambda_1 = \frac{5}{2} \eta c_{tr} \left[1 - \frac{c_{rot}}{c_{tr}} \frac{5/2\eta - \rho \mathfrak{D}}{2p\tau} \right]$$

$$\lambda_2 = \rho \mathfrak{D} c_{rot} \left[1 + \frac{5/2\eta - \rho \mathfrak{D}}{2p\tau} \right]$$

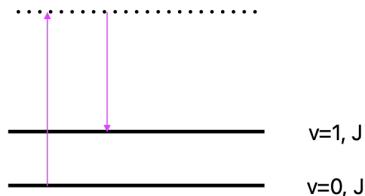


Source

Viscosity and Thermal Conductivity Equations for Nitrogen, Oxygen, Argon, and Air
E.W. Lemmon, R.T. Jacobsen, *International Journal of Thermophysics* **25** 21 (2004)

Raman scattering

Line mixing in the isotropic fundamental Q branch



$$\Gamma_j = -\frac{1}{2\pi c_0} \sum_{i \neq j} W_{ij} \quad (1)$$

$$K_{ij} = 2\pi c_0 k_B T W_{ij} \quad (2)$$

Sitz & Farrow

- $J = 0 - 14$
- $T = 298 \text{ K}$

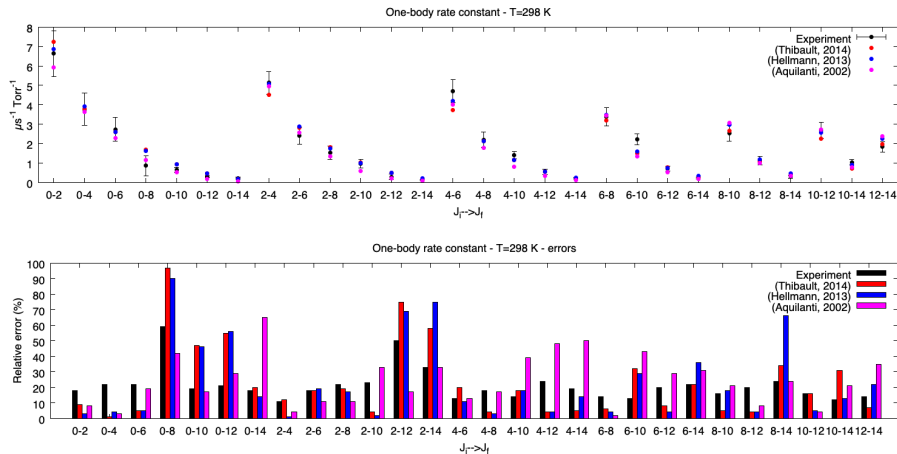
Calculation

- $K_{ij} = \sum_k \frac{n_k}{n} \sum_l K_{ij}^{kl}$
- $J_{max} = 26, \Delta J_{max} = 16$

Pump-probe measurements of state-to-state rotational energy transfer rates in N_2 ($v=1$)
 G.O. Sitz, R.L. Farrow, *J. Chem. Phys.* **93** 7883 (1990)

Raman scattering

Results for One-body rates at $T = 298\text{ K}$



Line coupling effects in the isotropic Raman spectra of N_2 : A quantum calculation at room temperature
 F. Thibault, C. Boulet, Q. Ma, *J. Chem. Phys.* **140** 044303 (2014)

Rotational relaxation

Bulk viscosity

$$\eta_V = \frac{c_{int}}{c_v^2} p \tau = \frac{c_{int}}{c_v^2} \frac{\pi}{4} \eta Z = \left(\frac{c_{int}}{c_v} \right)^2 \frac{k_B T}{2 \left[\left[(\Delta \epsilon)^2 \right] \right]}$$

Rotational relaxation number (Parker 1959)

$$Z = Z_\infty \left[1 + \frac{\pi \sqrt{\pi}}{2} \sqrt{\frac{T_0}{T}} + \left(\frac{\pi^2}{4} + 2 \right) \frac{T_0}{T} + \pi \sqrt{\pi} \left(\frac{T_0}{T} \right)^{\frac{3}{2}} \right]^{-1}$$

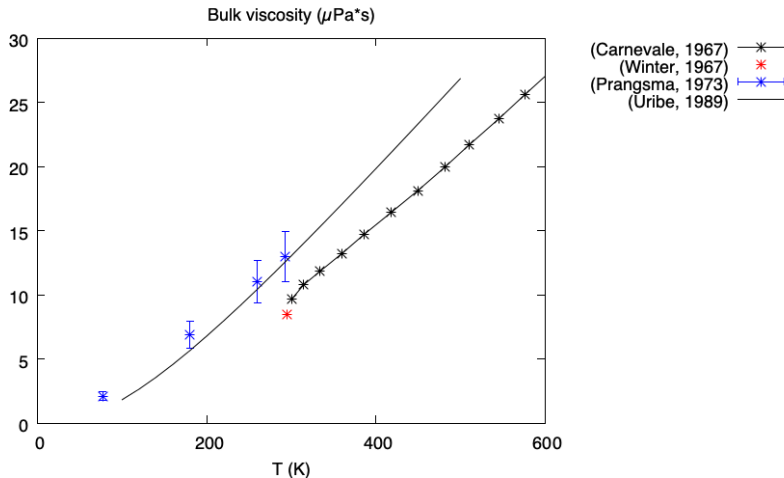
Sound absorption coefficient

$$\Gamma = \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{1}{\rho} \left(\frac{4}{3} \eta + \eta_V \right) + (\gamma - 1) \frac{\lambda}{\rho c_p} \right]$$

Rotational and Vibrational Relaxation in Diatomic Gases

J.G. Parker, *Physics of Fluids* 2 449 (1959)

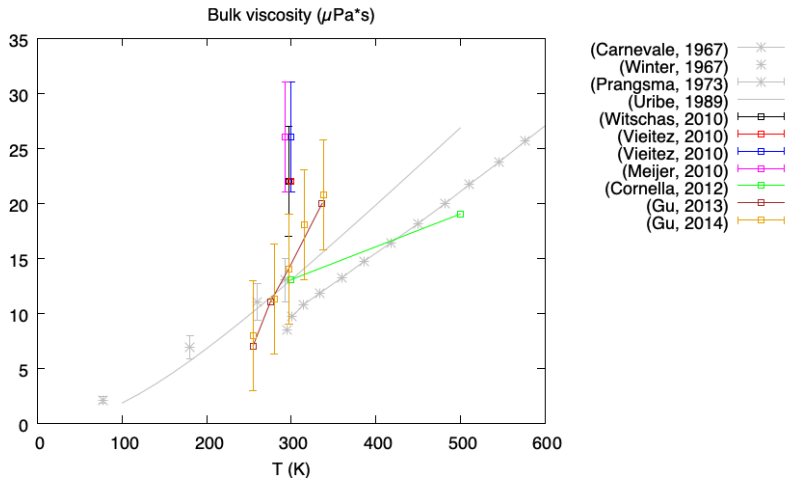
Literature results: ultrasound absorption



Thermal conductivity of nine polyatomic gases at low density

F. J. Uribe, E. A. Mason, J. Kestin, *Journal of Physical and Chemical Reference Data* **19** 1123 (1990).

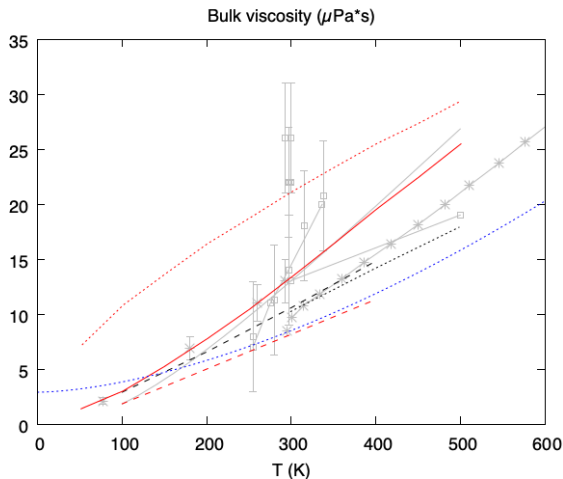
Literature results: RBS/CRBS



Finding the bulk viscosity of air from Rayleigh-Brillouin light scattering spectra

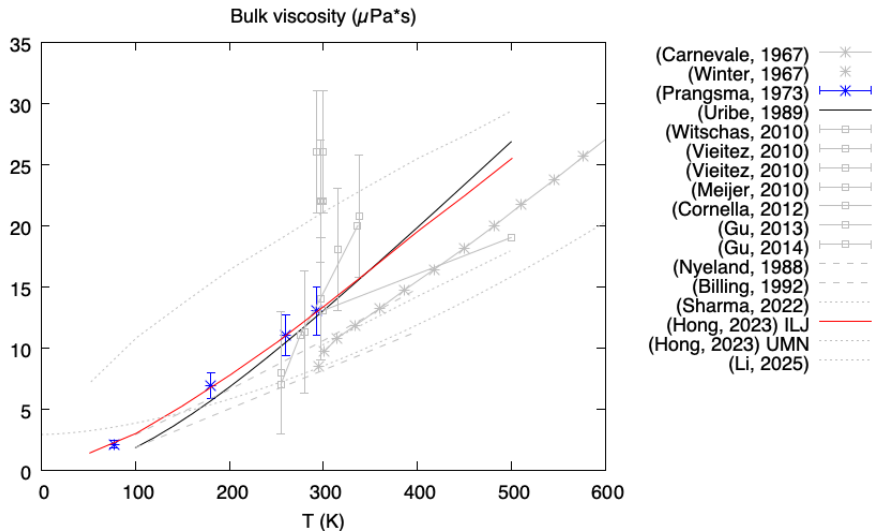
D. Bruno, A. Frezzotti, S.H. Jamali, W. van de Water, *J. Chem. Phys.* **158** 031101 (2023).

Literature results: PES

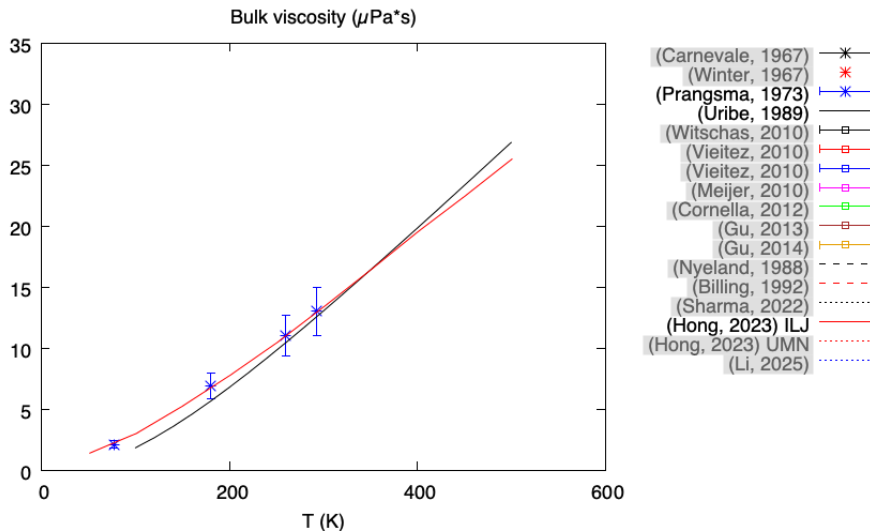


- (Carnevale, 1967) *
- (Winter, 1967) *
- (Prangma, 1973) *
- (Uribe, 1989) *
- (Witschas, 2010) *
- (Vieitez, 2010) *
- (Vieitez, 2010) *
- (Meijer, 2010) *
- (Cornella, 2012) *
- (Gu, 2013) *
- (Gu, 2014) *
- (Nyeland, 1988) - - -
- (Billing, 1992) - - -
- (Sharma, 2022) . . .
- (Hong, 2023) ILJ —
- (Hong, 2023) UMN —
- (Li, 2025) . . .

Literature results: reference



Literature results: reference



Bulk viscosity

Calculation approaches

- Monte Carlo evaluation of collision integrals (1st C-E approximation)

Classical theory of transport phenomena in dilute polyatomic gases

*N. Taxman, Phys. Rev. **110** 1235 (1958).*

- Homogenous relaxation

$$\eta_V = \frac{c_{int}}{c_v^2} p \tau$$

- Green-Kubo expression (Equilibrium simulation)

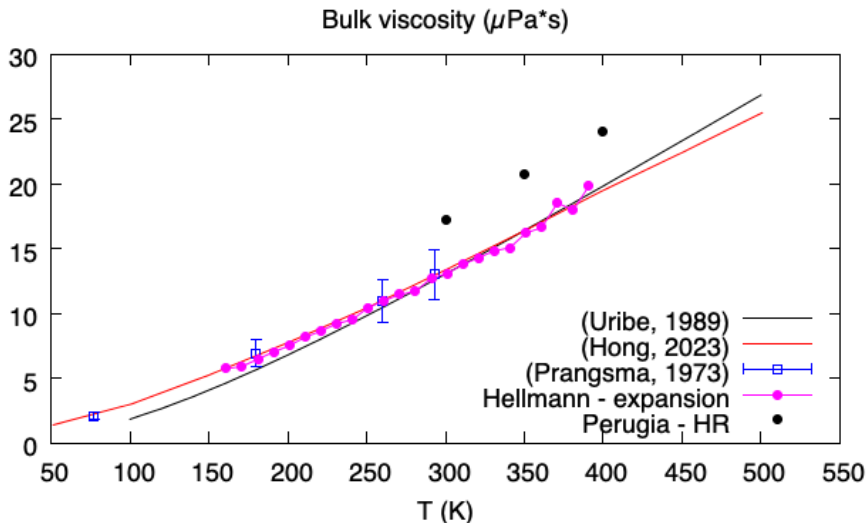
$$\frac{4}{3}\eta + \eta_V = \frac{1}{Vk_B T} \int \langle \mathbf{P}(0) : \mathbf{P}(t) \rangle dt$$

- Adiabatic expansion (Non-eq simulation)

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial t} - \frac{\delta}{3} \mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{v}} f = C(f, f)$$

Bulk viscosity

Results



Rotational relaxation

Role of inelastic collisions

OBR

$$K_{ij} = \sum_k \frac{n_k}{n} \sum_l K_{ij}^{kl}$$

$$J_{max} = 26$$

$$\Delta J_{max} = 16$$

Bulk viscosity

$$\eta_V = \left(\frac{c_{int}}{c_v} \right)^2 \frac{k_B T}{2 \left[\left[(\Delta \epsilon)^2 \right] \right]}$$

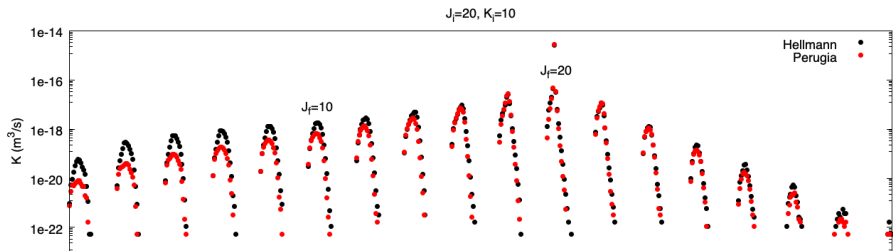
$$\left[\left[(\Delta \epsilon)^2 \right] \right] = \frac{1}{8} \sum_{i,j,k,l} (\Delta \epsilon)^2 \frac{n_i}{n} \frac{n_j}{n} K_{ij}^{kl}$$

$$J_{max} = 30$$

$$\Delta J_{max} = 26$$

Results

Two-body rates



Conclusions

- Classical Trajectories are used to evaluate transport properties from PES
- Properties that depend mostly on isotropic interaction show good agreement with experiment: η , $\mathfrak{D}$, λ
- Rotational relaxation rates match the results of Raman experiments for low inelasticity
- Strongly inelastic transitions show important differences. These can be revealed from bulk viscosity measurements.

Outlook and future plans

Can we derive conclusions on the PES?

- Rotational relaxation is caused by the anisotropic part of the potential
- Look at the 3rd PES (Cappelletti, 2008), used in Raman studies (Thibault, 2014) and vibrational kinetics (Hong, 2023)

Numerical estimation of N_2 bulk viscosity

- **Objective:** simulations of gas expansions with constant divergence δ .
- **Theory:** Physics can be cast as a **space homogeneous problem**. The local gas expansion, as seen by an observer moving with the bulk velocity is governed by the following Boltzmann equation:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial t} - \frac{\delta}{3} \mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{v}} f = C(f, f)$$

- $f(\mathbf{v}, \gamma, t)$ is the **phase averaged** distribution function of molecular velocity $\mathbf{v}$ and angular momentum γ .
- $C(f, f)$ describes binary collisions between linear rigid rotators, under the action of intermolecular forces derived by the PES.

A particle method

- CT-DSMC particle scheme more conveniently formulated from the equivalent form of the above BE:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial t} - \frac{\delta}{3} \nabla_{\mathbf{v}} \cdot (\mathbf{v} f) + \delta f = C(f, f)$$

- The **third term** on l.h.s. makes the density ρ vary as:

$$\rho(t) = \rho(0) \exp(-\delta t)$$

- The **second term** causes an **isotropic velocity rescaling** which increases or decreases T_t , depending on the sign of δ .
- The **second term** acts only on the **translational degrees of freedom**.
- The **coupling with rotational degrees of freedom** is provided by the collision term, $C(f, f)$.

References - I

Ultrasound absorption

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- 2 T.G. Winter, G.L. Hill, High-Temperature Ultrasonic Measurements of Rotational Relaxation in Hydrogen, Deuterium, Nitrogen, and Oxygen, *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America* **42**(4) 848-858 (1967)
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Rotational relaxation

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RBS/CRBS

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- 5 Z. Gu, W. Ubachs, Temperature-dependent bulk viscosity of nitrogen gas determined from spontaneous Rayleigh-Brillouin scattering, *Optics Letters* **38** 1110 (2013)
- 6 Z. Gu, W. Ubachs, A systematic study of Rayleigh-Brillouin scattering in air, N_2 , and O_2 gases, *The Journal of Chemical Physics* **141** 104320 (2014)

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Molecular dynamics

- ① C. Nyeland, G.D. Billing, Transport Coefficients of Diatomic Gases: Internal-State Analysis for Rotational and Vibrational Degrees of Freedom, *J. Phys. Chem.* **92** 1752 (1988)
- ② G.D. Billing, L. Wang, Semiclassical Calculations of Transport Coefficients and Rotational Relaxation of Nitrogen at High Temperatures, *J. Phys. Chem.* **96** 2572 (1992)
- ③ B. Sharma, R. Kumar, P. Gupta, S. Pareek, A. Singh, On the estimation of bulk viscosity of dilute nitrogen gas using equilibrium molecular dynamics approach, *Physics of Fluids* **34** 057104 (2022)
- ④ Q. Hong, L. Storch, Q. Sun, M. Bartolomei, F. Pirani, C. Coletti, *Journal of Chemical Theory and Computation* **19** 8557 (2023)
- ⑤ Y. Li, J. Zhang, Gas viscosity from first principles: A case study on nitrogen, *Physics of Fluids* **37** 087137 (2025)

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- 3 R. Hellmann, *Ab initio* potential energy surface for the nitrogen molecule pair and thermophysical properties of nitrogen gas, *Molecular Physics* **111** 387 (2013)
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Bruno & Frezzotti

- 1 D. Bruno, A. Frezzotti, Classical Trajectories Estimation of Air Species Transport Properties and Rotational Relaxation Rates, Proceedings of the 4th European Conference on Non-equilibrium Gas Flows - NEGF23, 29-31 March, 2023, Eindhoven, the Netherlands (2023)
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Raman line broadening

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NIST

- 1 E.W. Lemmon, R.T. Jacobsen, Viscosity and Thermal Conductivity Equations for Nitrogen, Oxygen, Argon, and Air, *International Journal of Thermophysics* **25** 21 (2004)